



VR movie theater at home

On December 3, a half-an-hour 3D version of 'Top Gun' will be available on bigscreenvr.com. <http://digit.in/PM-VR>



The Stanford Marshmallow Experiment

The tendency to delay gratification might be a good factor in predicting the success of individuals later in life. Read more about the experiment here: <http://digit.in/masrshm>

To binge or not to binge...

Is binge watching making us dumb?

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If you come across a new show that's already a few seasons into the plot, and you decide to watch it... do you watch one or two episodes, and then take a break to get back to life, or do you binge watch entire seasons in one sitting? If you're a member of the latter, first of all, welcome to the club, and secondly, you're not going to like this article...

Look, we get it! We can't bear to not know what happens next when each episode ends in a cliffhanger. It's like all shows are designed to be binge watched! If you have no choice but to wait a week, such as when watching a show that's airing live, then that feeling passes. We are able to deal with it when forced to... it just seems impossible when the next episode is sitting just there, waiting to be played... or worse, on a service like Netflix, when the next episode autoplays as soon as the current one finishes!

Then there's the idea of being able to remember the storyline better when binge watching. Many of us choose to binge on one or two seasons in just a couple of days!

DRAWBACKS

There are two main adverse effects of binge watching. The first is that it can lose you some friends. You might be able to function after watching an entire season for 13 hours straight on a Sunday, but other people might have lives. Knowing everything that happens in a

season, while your friends don't, leaves you with a lot of room for slip ups. Besides, you then have the temptation to spoil things for them on purpose, because there is a perverse sense of power over those who have not caught up to you!

You *could* all collectively agree to binge, and even make plans, but chances are, someone is going to miss out because life gets in the way. What then? The opposite (no-bingeing), is easier to achieve because it requires less of a time commitment from everyone.

For those who have more time on their hands, they can re-watch the episode to try and catch some insights that they missed the first time. This builds more appreciation for story.

You could also go online and indulge in some fan theory for a change.

Needless to say, being a couch potato is terrible for your health, so binge watching should be a no-no just based on the health hazards – heart disease, diabetes, obesity, etc.

IS IT MAKING US DUMB?

The answer would be a re-sounding yes. We are missing out on the whole point of consuming visual media – the post watch digestion. None of us sits and thinks anymore. There's no mulling over what we saw, trying to think for ourselves. It's just sit and stare and consume and then shut down. It's a slow strangulation of curiosity, and it's going to gradually but surely make us dumber. We won't want to ask "Why" and will just move on to what's next!

WHO TO BLAME?

No one, and also everyone! It's not like the entertainment providers started

this... so many of us used to binge-watch and binge-re-watch so many different things. Old series (which weren't even available easily) were being torrented and binge watched long before Netflix decided to turn into an enabler! We are to blame.

Then again, while some of us would binge watch before the studios decided to feed our addiction, most of us didn't. It took the providers embracing binge-watching to turn us into droopy eyed zombies. Show creators insist on ending on a cliff hanger – old serials would do that far less, trying to make each episode satisfying.

Paid services such as Prime and Netflix, just want you to be hooked to their content, and thus readily release many episodes of a single season in one shot. Sometimes they release entire seasons. Plus, they also have a large catalogue of older serials that they also want you to watch, so the enable you by making it easy to skip intros, or jumping to the next episode, and running season recaps, etc., all designed to keep you hooked. They also push other serials based on your history, in order to keep you glued to their service.

WHAT DO WE DO?

We need a compromise. Perhaps show makers could slow down releases a little. They might not want to, fearing a loss of interest, but maybe five episodes a week, or three, could be a compromise that force the binge-watchers to stop and go out to get some air and exercise! Then again, this depends on us actually wanting to control our binge watching. Will any of you try and control the urge after reading this article? Write in and tell us, and suggest some ways in which we can control bingeing! 📺